withdrawal of Soviet troops from Afghanistan, we have maintained the view that a political and negotiated way must be found to facilitate the Soviet withdrawal. We have also made it clear to the US that further induction of arms into Pakistan would only aggravate tensions in the region. The US administration has even acknowledged that its assistance for Pakistan should be seen only from the point of view of Soviet presence in Afghanistan and bears no relevance to India-Pak relations.

Geoffrey Kemp of the US National Security Council was a staunch supporter of the USA arms shipments to Pakistan. In a meeting of the India-USA business council in June 1981, Kemp said the USA was increasing its defence expenditure to protect western interests in southwest Asia. He hinted at a continuous arms supply to the Afghan mujahideen through Pakistan. On 9 July 1981, the Berne based newspaper Neue Zurcher Zeitung carried a front page story with a Washington dateline suggesting that the USA arms supply to Pakistan was a sort of punishment to India for failing to oppose the Soviet Union on Afghan soil and the Soviet-Vietnam interference in Cambodia. A month later the Indian government refused to accept George Griffin as the political counselor at the US embassy in New Delhi. This was an unprecedented move. It was alleged that Griffin was leading the CIA operation against the Afghanistan government.

Meanwhile, insurgency powered by American weapons increased during the first fortnight of January 1982, with the rebels dominating the main market areas of Kandahar. Besides attacking the corps HQ, the rebels attacked the governor's office on two occasions, killing five guards on duty near the outer boundary wall. They also attacked the Kandahar radio station